

أَعُوذُ بِاللّٰهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللّٰهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 23

The Murakkab Idafi

1. The definition of the Murakkab Idafi

In the phrase *Murakkab Idafi*, the word *idafi* comes from *إِضَافَةٌ*, and *idafah* means *relation or connection*.

Definition: A construction of at least two nouns in which one noun is related to another, or a connection is established between one noun and another, is called a *Murakkab Idafi*.

Worth remembering: Like the *Murakkab Tawsifi* and the *Murakkab Isharee*, the *Murakkab Idafi* too is a *Murakkab Naqis*. That is, it does not by itself form a sentence but becomes one element of a sentence. Saying "the limits of Allah" does not complete the sense.

2. The marks of a Murakkab Idafi in translation

In English the construction is generally rendered with *of*, with the *possessive 's*, or with a *possessive pronoun*. Urdu marks it in three ways as well.

Urdu mark	Example in translation	Arabic example
ka , ki , ke	Zayd's house , Ahmad's book	بَيْتُ زَيْدٍ
wala , wali , wale	the people of the cave	أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ
ra , ri , re	my book	كِتَابِي

3. The two elements of a Murakkab Idafi

- Mudaf* — the noun that is related to another, or whose connection with another noun is established, is called the *Mudaf*.
- Mudaf Ilayh* — the noun to which the relation is made, or with which the connection is established, is called the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

The rule of order: Unlike Urdu, in Arabic the **Mudaf** comes first and the **Mudaf Ilayh** after it. Urdu says "Zayd ka ghar" — Zayd first. But Arabic says **بَيْتُ زَيْدٍ** — the house first. English behaves like Arabic here: "the house of Zayd".

بَيْتُ زَيْدٍ

Mudaf + Mudaf Ilayh
(Zayd's house)

A **Murakkab Idafi** comes into being when the rules proper to each of these two elements have been applied to them.

4. The rules of the Mudaf

- **اَلْ** does not enter the **Mudaf**.
- The **I'raab** of the **Mudaf** is light.
- The **Mudaf** may come in all three states of **I'raab** — **Marfoo'**, **Mansoob** and **Majroor** — that is, it is **Mu'rab**.

How the I'raab is made light

Two principles: First: for those kinds of noun that take **Tanween**, the **Tanween** is removed. Second: for the **Tathniyah** (masculine and feminine) and the **Jam' Salim Mudhakkar**, the final noon is dropped.

Kind	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
singular masculine	كِتَابٌ ← كِتَابُ	كِتَابًا ← كِتَابِ	كِتَابٍ ← كِتَابِ
singular feminine	جَنَّةٌ ← جَنَّةُ	جَنَّةً ← جَنَّةُ	جَنَّةٍ ← جَنَّةِ
Jam' Mukassar	أَصْحَابُ ← أَصْحَابُ	أَصْحَابًا ← أَصْحَابِ	أَصْحَابٍ ← أَصْحَابِ
Jam' Salim Mu'annath	آيَاتُ ← آيَاتُ	آيَاتٍ ← آيَاتِ	آيَاتٍ ← آيَاتِ

The dropping of the noon in the Tathniyah and Jam' Salim Mudhakkar

Kind	Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb wal Jarr
Tathniyah	كِتَابَانِ ← كِتَابَا	كِتَابَيْنِ ← كِتَابَيَّ
Tathniyah	يَدَانِ ← يَدَا	يَدَيْنِ ← يَدَيَّ
Jam' Salim Mudhakkar	بَنُونَ ← بَنُو	بَنِينَ ← بَنِيَّ

This is why the Qur'an has تَبَّتْ يَدَايَ لِيْ لَهَبٍ and not يَدَانِ — because يَدَا is the *Mudaf* here.

5. The rules of the Mudaf Ilayh

- The *Mudaf Ilayh* is always in the state of jarr.
- Both اَلْ and *Tanween* may come upon the *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- اَلْ is generally placed upon the *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- Sometimes the *Mudaf Ilayh* is *Ma'rifah* even without اَلْ, as in كِتَابُ رَّيْدٍ — here the *Mudaf Ilayh* is already *Ma'rifah*, so there is no need to place اَلْ upon it.

Agreement is not required: Unlike the *Murakkab Tawsifi*, agreement between the *Mudaf* and the *Mudaf Ilayh* in number and gender is not required. The *Mudaf* may be masculine and the *Mudaf Ilayh* feminine, or the *Mudaf* singular and the *Mudaf Ilayh* plural.

6. The I'raab and Wus'at of a Murakkab Idafi

Aspect	By what it is determined	Example
I'raab	By the Mudaf. Whatever state of I'raab the Mudaf is in is taken as the state of the whole Murakkab Idafi, since the Mudaf Ilayh is always in the state of jarr.	رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ a Majroor Murakkab Idafi
Wus'at	By the Mudaf Ilayh. If the Mudaf Ilayh is Nakirah the whole construction is Nakirah, and if it is Ma'rifah the whole construction is Ma'rifah.	عِلْمُ الْغَيْبِ a Ma'rifah Murakkab Idafi مِثْقَالُ ذَرَّةٍ a Nakirah Murakkab Idafi

Two separate things: Fix this point in mind particularly: the *I'raab* is read from the *Mudaf*, but the *wus'at* from the *Mudaf Ilayh*. A different element has to be looked at for each.

7. When the Mudaf Ilayh comes as Nakirah

When the *Mudaf Ilayh* is brought as *Nakirah* in Arabic, the purpose is to give force to the statement.

The rule of translation: If the *Mudaf Ilayh* comes as *Nakirah*, it is rendered with *any, some or a*.

- مِثْقَالُ ذَرَّةٍ — the weight of any speck at all
- غَابِرُ سَبِيلٍ — one crossing some road

8. Qur'anic examples of the Murakkab Idafi

Murakkab Idafi	Translation	Mudaf · Mudaf Ilayh
حُدُودُ اللَّهِ	the limits of Allah	حُدُودٌ · اللَّهِ
عَذَابُ النَّارِ	the punishment of the Fire	عَذَابٌ · النَّارِ
ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ	the taster of death	ذَائِقَةٌ · الْمَوْتِ
يَوْمُ الْقِيَمَةِ	the Day of Resurrection	يَوْمٌ · الْقِيَمَةِ
بَيْتُ إِسْمَاعِيلَ	the house of Isma'il	بَيْتٌ · إِسْمَاعِيلَ
مَقَامُ إِبْرَاهِيمَ	the standing place of Ibrahim	مَقَامٌ · إِبْرَاهِيمَ
وَرَقُ الْجَنَّةِ	the leaves of the Garden	وَرَقٌ · الْجَنَّةِ
خَشْيَةُ اللَّهِ	the fear of Allah	خَشْيَةٌ · اللَّهِ
عَذَابُ اللَّهِ	the punishment of Allah	عَذَابٌ · اللَّهِ
نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ	the she-camel of Allah	نَاقَةٌ · اللَّهِ
فِي أَمَانِ اللَّهِ	in the protection of Allah	أَمَانٌ · اللَّهِ

These examples also make plain that agreement in number and gender is not required between the *Mudaf* and the *Mudaf Ilayh*. In نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ the *Mudaf* is feminine and the *Mudaf Ilayh* masculine, and in حُدُودُ اللَّهِ the *Mudaf* is plural and the *Mudaf Ilayh* singular.

9. The names of the days and of the prayers

All the names of the days of the week are used in the form of a *Murakkab Idafi*, and so are the names of the prayers.

Names of the days	Names of the prayers
يَوْمُ الْجُمُعَةِ (Friday)	صَلَاةُ الْفَجْرِ
يَوْمُ السَّبْتِ (Saturday)	صَلَاةُ الظُّهْرِ
يَوْمُ الدِّينِ (the Day of Recompense)	صَلَاةُ الْعَصْرِ
يَوْمُ الْقِيَمَةِ (the Day of Resurrection)	صَلَاةُ الْمَغْرِبِ
	صَلَاةُ الْعِشَاءِ

10. Kull, Ba'd and Ghayr

Certain words come almost always as the *Mudaf*, such as كُلٌّ, بَعْضٌ and غَيْرٌ.

Arabic	Translation
كُلُّ مُحَدَّثَةٍ بِدْعَةٌ	every newly invented matter in religion is an innovation
كُلُّ بِدْعَةٍ ضَلَالَةٌ	every innovation is a going astray
كُلُّ ضَلَالَةٍ فِي النَّارِ	every going astray leads to the Fire
كُلُّ الطَّعَامِ	all the food, the whole of the food
غَيْرُ اللَّهِ	other than Allah, besides Allah
بَعْضُ الْكِتَابِ	part of the book

Worth noting: In the first three examples the *Mudaf Ilayh* is *Nakirah* — مُحَدَّثَةٍ, بِدْعَةٍ and ضَلَالَةٍ — which is why they are rendered with "every". In the fourth the *Mudaf Ilayh* is *Ma'rifah*, so the rendering became "all".

11. The Tathniyah and Jam' Salim in the construction

11.1 In the Mudaf Ilayh

When a *Tathniyah* or a *Jam' Salim* becomes the *Mudaf Ilayh*, it takes the *I'raab* of the state of *jarr* and its noon remains — because the noon drops only from the *Mudaf*, not from the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam' Salim
بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمِ	بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ	بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ
بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمَةِ	بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمَاتِ	بَيْتُ الْمُسْلِمَاتِ

11.2 In the Mudaf

When a *Tathniyah* or a *Jam' Salim* is itself the *Mudaf*, its noon drops away, and its form changes according to the state of *I'raab*.

Kind	Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb wal Jarr
Wahid	مُسْلِمٌ مَكَّةَ	مُسْلِمٍ / مُسْلِمٍ مَكَّةَ
Tathniyah	مُسْلِمَا مَكَّةَ	مُسْلِمَي مَكَّةَ
Jam' Salim	مُسْلِمُونَ مَكَّةَ	مُسْلِمِي مَكَّةَ

Qur'anic examples

- مُقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةِ (Marfoo') and مُقِيمِي الصَّلَاةِ (Mansoob and Majroor) — those who establish the prayer
- صَاحِبَا السِّجْنِ (Marfoo') and صَاحِبِي السِّجْنِ (Mansoob and Majroor) — the two companions of the prison

12. Some further important points

12.1 The answer to La-Rasoolullah

In Lecture 12 a question arose over the verse of Surah al-Munafiqun: why does رَسُولٌ carry no *Tanween*, when Rasool is neither *Ghayr Munsarif* nor does it carry the *Lam ut Ta'reef*? The full answer is now before us.

The answer: رَسُولُ اللَّهِ is a *Murakkab Idafi* in which رَسُولٌ is the *Mudaf* and اللَّهُ the *Mudaf Ilayh*. And the rule of the *Mudaf* is precisely this, that its *I'raab* is made light — that is, its *Tanween* is removed. Likewise in رَسُولُهُ the pronoun is the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

12.2 A pronoun as the Mudaf Ilayh

The *Mudaf Ilayh* is not always an openly stated noun; a pronoun may serve as the *Mudaf Ilayh* too. In that case the pronoun is attached to the end of the *Mudaf*.

- كِتَابُهُ — his book
- كِتَابُكَ — your book
- كِتَابِي — my book

This is the case for which Urdu uses the mark "ra, ri, re", and English the possessive pronoun.

12.3 A chain of idafah

Sometimes a *Mudaf Ilayh* is itself the *Mudaf* of another noun, and so a chain of *idafah* is formed.

مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ

(Surah al-Fatihah: 4)

- مَالِكِ is the *Mudaf*, and يَوْمِ is its *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- يَوْمِ has itself become a *Mudaf*, and الدِّينِ is its *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- This is why يَوْمِ carries neither *Tanween* nor *alif lam* — because it is a *Mudaf*. And it carries a kasrah, because it is a *Mudaf Ilayh* as well.

12.4 The Asma' Sittah as Mudaf

In Lecture 12 it was seen that the *I'raab* of the *Asma' Sittah* appears through letters, and the first condition for this was that they be *Mudaf*. The reason for that is now plain.

- جَاءَ أَبُوكَ — state of *raf'*; the *Mudaf Ilayh* is the pronoun kaf
- رَأَيْتُ أَبَاكَ — state of *nasb*
- مَرَرْتُ بِأَبْنِكَ — state of *jarr*

13. The three Murakkabat Naqisah compared

Three *Murakkabat Naqisah* have now been studied. It is useful to see the difference between them at a glance.

Construction	Elements	Agreement	Example
Murakkab Tawsifi	Mawsuf + Sifah	complete agreement in all four aspects	أَلْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ
Murakkab Isharee	Ism ul Isharah + Mushar Ilayh	in gender, number and I'raab; both Ma'rifah	هَذَا الْكِتَابُ
Murakkab Idafi	Mudaf + Mudaf Ilayh	agreement in number and gender not required	بَيْتُ زَيْنٍ

An easy way to tell them apart: Look at the second noun. If it carries a **kasrah**, this is a *Murakkab Idafi*. If it carries the same *I'raab* as the first noun, a *Murakkab Tawsifi*. And if the first word is something like هَذَا or ذَلِكَ, a *Murakkab Isharee*.

Summary

1. The word idafi comes from اِضَافَةٌ, which means relation or connection.
2. A construction of at least two nouns in which one is related to another is called a Murakkab Idafi.
3. The Murakkab Idafi too is a Murakkab Naqis; it is not a sentence but one element of a sentence.
4. In Urdu it is marked in three ways: ka ki ke, wala wali wale, and ra ri re. English uses "of", the possessive 's, or a possessive pronoun.
5. It has two elements: the Mudaf and the Mudaf Ilayh. The one related is the Mudaf, and the one to which it is related is the Mudaf Ilayh.
6. Unlike Urdu, in Arabic the Mudaf comes first and the Mudaf Ilayh after it.
7. The Mudaf has three rules: al- does not enter it, its l'raab is light, and it is Mu'rab, coming in all three states.
8. The l'raab is made light in two ways: the Tanween is removed, and the final noon of the Tathniyah and Jam' Salim Mudhakkar is dropped.
9. It is by this rule that the Qur'an has يَدَا اِنِّي لَهَبٌ and not يَدَانِ.
10. The Mudaf Ilayh is always in the state of jarr, and both al- and Tanween may come upon it.
11. Sometimes the Mudaf Ilayh is Ma'rifah even without al-, as in كِتَابُ زَيْدٍ.
12. Agreement in number and gender is not required between the Mudaf and the Mudaf Ilayh.
13. The l'raab of a Murakkab Idafi is determined by the Mudaf, since the Mudaf Ilayh is always Majroor.
14. The wus'at of a Murakkab Idafi is determined by the Mudaf Ilayh: if it is Nakirah the whole is Nakirah, and if Ma'rifah then the whole is Ma'rifah.
15. Bringing the Mudaf Ilayh as Nakirah gives force to the statement, and it is rendered with "any", "some" or "a".
16. All the names of the days and all the names of the prayers are used as a Murakkab Idafi.
17. Words such as كُلٌّ, بَعْضٌ and غَيْرٌ also come as the Mudaf.
18. When a Tathniyah or Jam' Salim is the Mudaf Ilayh its noon remains, and when it is the Mudaf the noon drops.
19. رَبُّنَا carries no Tanween precisely because رَبُّنَا is the Mudaf, and the l'raab of a Mudaf is light.
20. A pronoun may also be the Mudaf Ilayh, and it is this case that Urdu renders with ra, ri, re.
21. Sometimes the Mudaf Ilayh is itself a Mudaf, forming a chain of idafah, as in مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ.
22. The first condition for the l'raab bil Harf of the Asma' Sittah was that they be Mudaf, as in اَبَاكَ, اَبُوكَ and اَبِيكَ.

Exercise

1. Define the Murakkab Idafi and give the meaning of the word idafah.
2. Write all three Urdu marks of the Murakkab Idafi with examples.

3. Define the Mudaf and the Mudaf Ilayh and state their order.
4. Write all three rules of the Mudaf.
5. Explain both ways of making the I'raab of a noun light, with examples.
6. Turn the following into a Mudaf: كِتَابٌ , جَنَّةٌ , كِتَابَانِ , بُنُوتٌ.
7. Write all four rules of the Mudaf Ilayh.
8. By what is the I'raab of a Murakkab Idafi determined, and by what its wus'at? Explain with examples.
9. What is the purpose of bringing the Mudaf Ilayh as Nakirah, and how is it then translated?
10. Write the names of the days and of the prayers in the form of a Murakkab Idafi.
11. Give three examples with كُلٌّ and explain why the rendering differs between "every" and "all".
12. Using بَيْتٌ as the Mudaf, form six constructions with the Tathniyah and Jam' Salim in the Mudaf Ilayh.
13. Using مُسْلِمٌ as the Mudaf, write the singular, dual and plural forms in both states of I'raab.
14. Why does لَرَسُولُ اللَّهِ carry no Tanween? Give the full reason.
15. Analyse مَالِكِ يَوْمَ الدِّينِ and explain why يَوْمٌ carries neither Tanween nor al-, and why it carries a kasrah.
16. Set out the comparison of the three Murakkabat Naqisah in the form of a table.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ